

Gender

Many people think of gender as being female or male, and it's often thought to mean the same thing as biological sex (the hormones, sex organs, and genes a person has). In fact, it is much more complicated—a person's gender is determined by more than simply the anatomy they were born with.

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Explaining gender

Gender is a concept that works on two levels. On an individual level, it refers to a combination of a person's biological sex, their sense of who they are, and the choices they make about their behavior and appearance. But on a social level, gender is a subject that explores the traditional expectations a society has about how people should look and act.

▽ What is gender?

Gender is based on biological sex, gender identity, and gender expression.

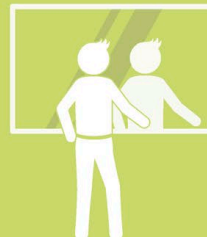
Biological sex

This refers to the physical characteristics with which a person is born. Some people are born male, others female. Some are intersex, which means that their biology has both male and female characteristics.



Gender identity

This is whether individuals personally think, feel, and see themselves as a man, woman, or other gender. No one else can tell someone what their gender identity is.



Gender expression

This is the way in which individuals present themselves to society through their appearance and behavior. Gender expression may or may not match a person's gender identity. It may also change depending on who they are with.



A spectrum of genders

Rather than just recognizing female and male, gender can be thought of as a wide spectrum of identities. There are many ways for a person to describe how they identify their gender.

Cisgender

When a person's gender identity matches what their culture expects of them given their biological sex.

Transgender

Someone whose gender identity differs from what society expects given their sex at birth, such as they identify as a woman but were born male.

Agender

This term describes someone who feels they don't belong to either gender; they don't feel like either a woman or a man.

▷ Diversity

There are an enormous range of gender identities. This list does not include all of them.